Parallels® Desktop

The Mac-Native Way to Deliver Windows Apps, Powered by Parallels Desktop



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Parallels®

About the speakers

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- Based in Philadelphia, PA

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- Based in Vancouver, Canada

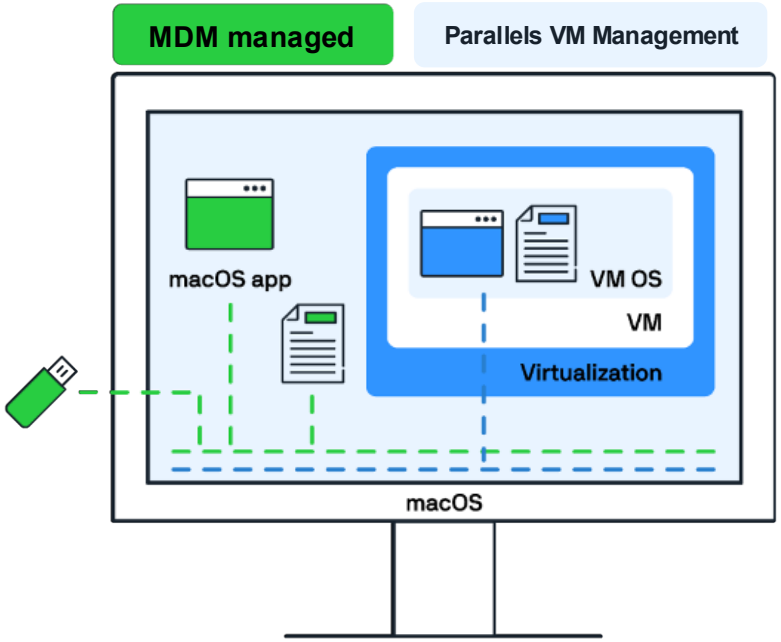
Agenda

What we'll cover today

- **Where we are today** – Parallels Desktop Enterprise and the last 12 months
- **The core shift** – the big change: deliver the app, not the OS
- **The admin experience** – packaging and deploying Windows apps through your MDM
- **The end-user experience** – Windows apps that launch like native Mac apps
- **The security model** – Windows as a sealed runtime, not a second endpoint
- **Summary and discussion**

Take control of your users' VMs

Parallels Desktop Enterprise Edition offers control options on all levels. From unmanaged access to individual app provisioning, IT can choose the depth of oversight that balances security, flexibility, and user experience.



Manage Access

Provision

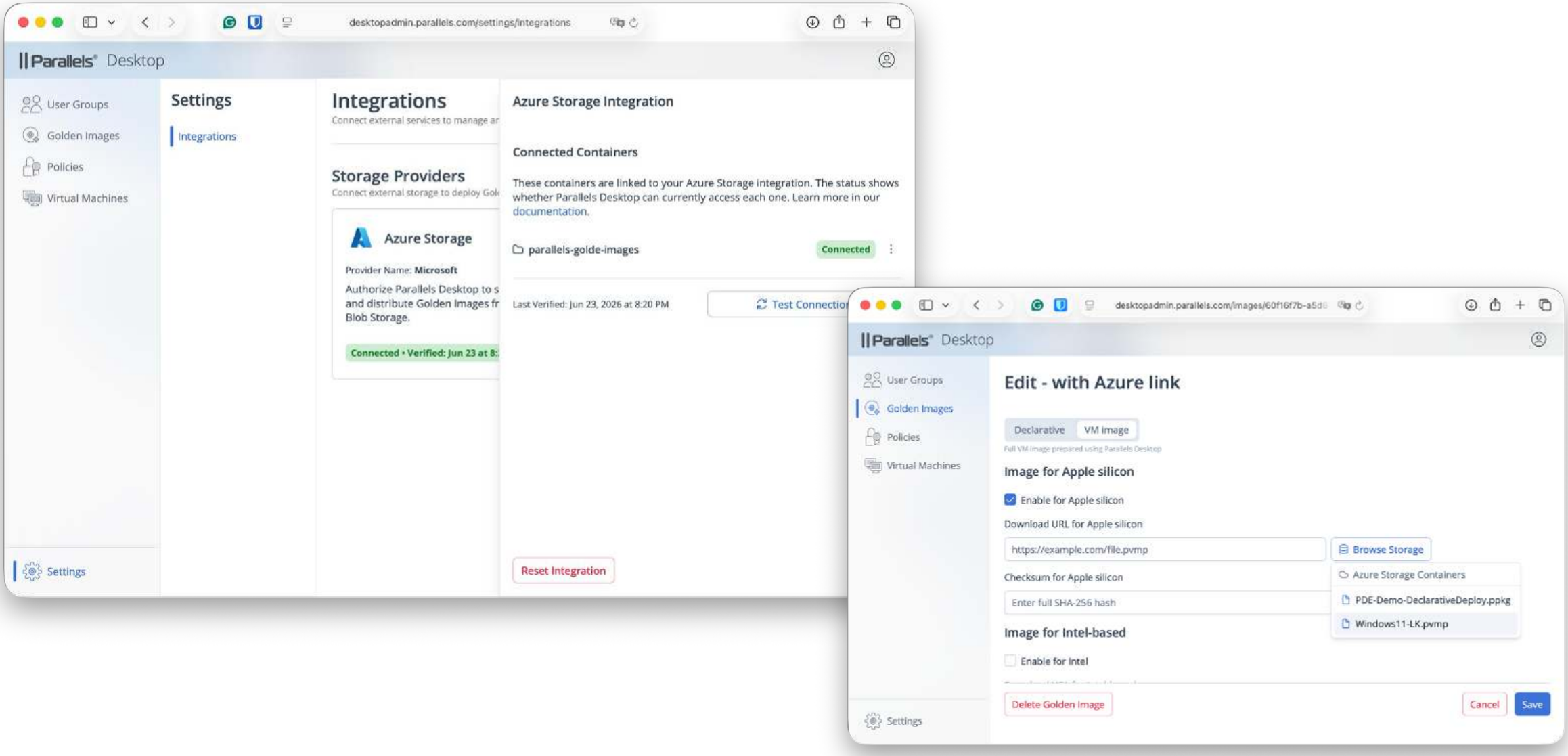
Monitor

Secure

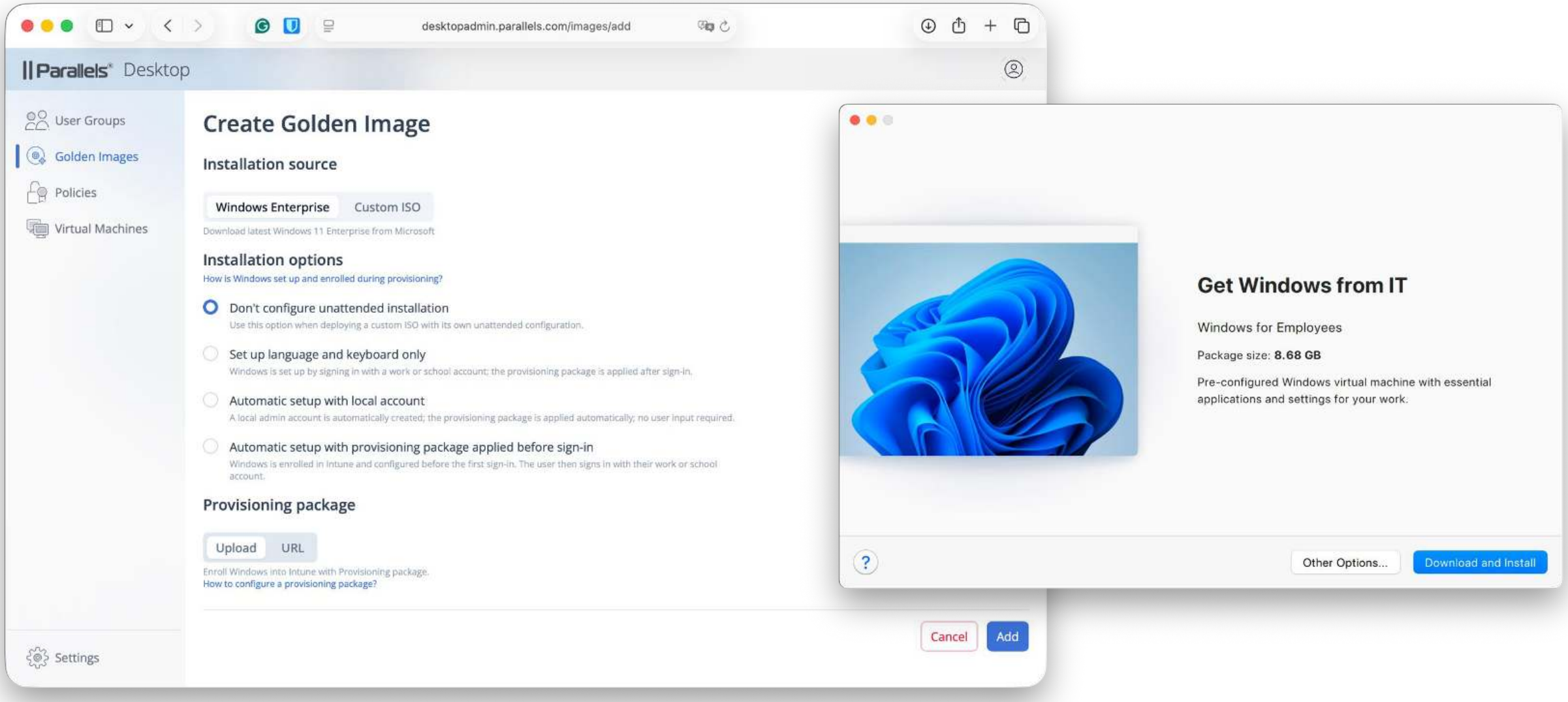
Parallels Desktop for Enterprise

Features loved by customers today

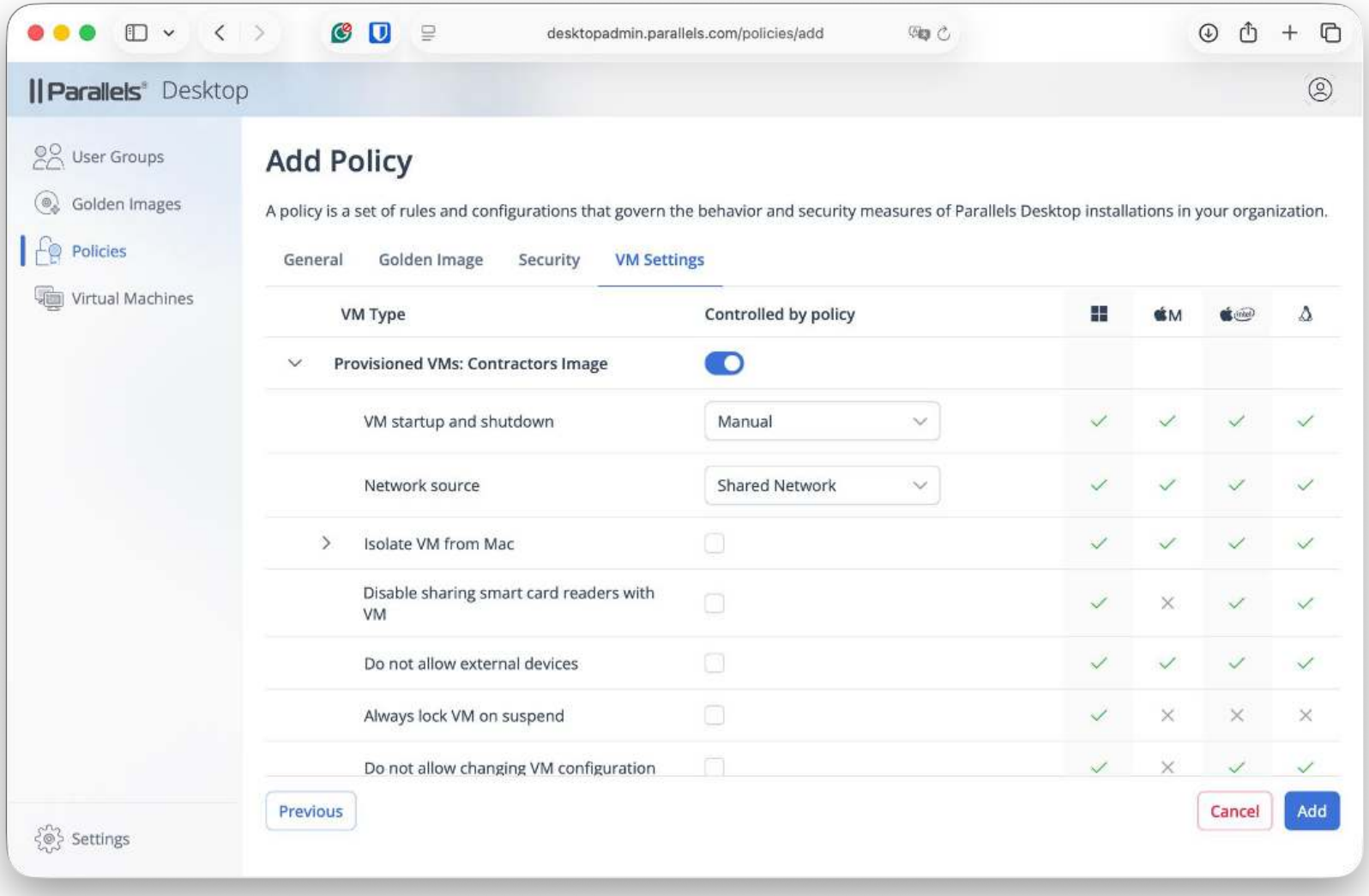
Secure Golden Image Delivery from Azure Storage



Declarative Deployment of Golden Images



Control VM settings via Parallels Policies



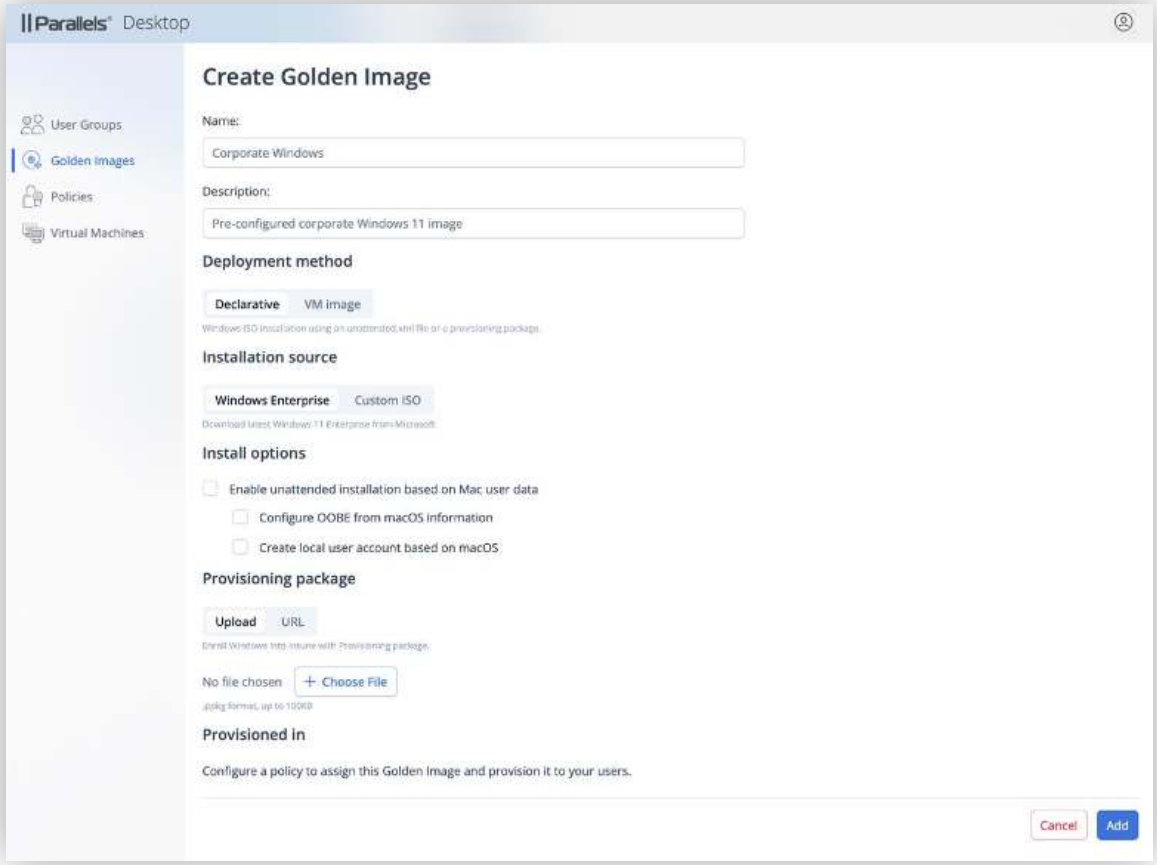
Parallels Desktop App Delivery

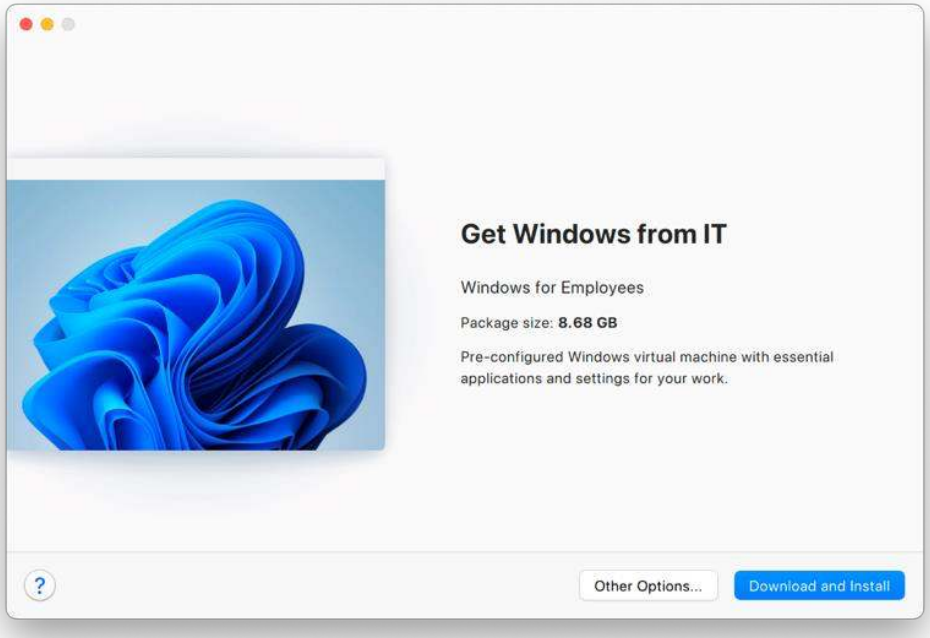
Coming soon to a Mac near you!

This presentation includes features that are in development and not yet released.
Functionality, availability, and timing are subject to change without notice.

VM Delivery: VM + OS + App

CURRENT · VM-FOCUSED

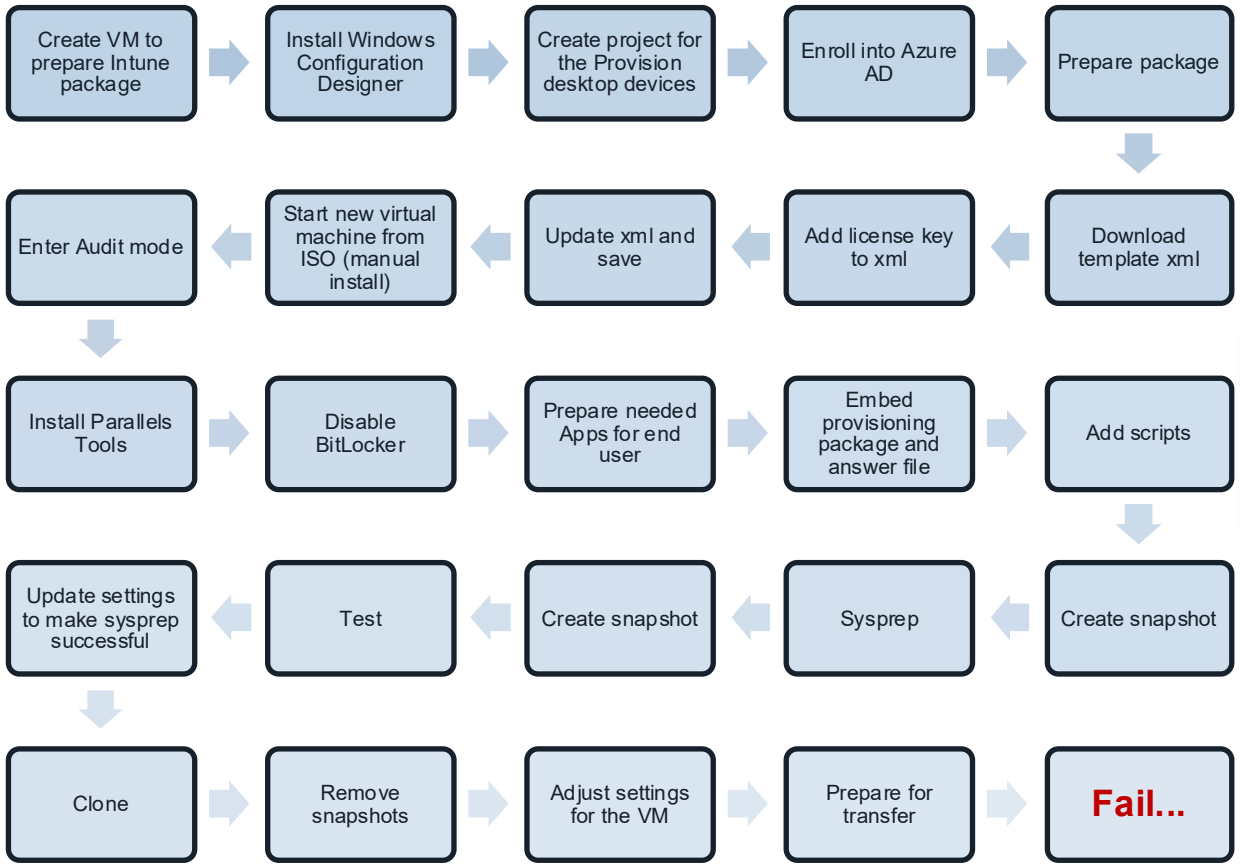


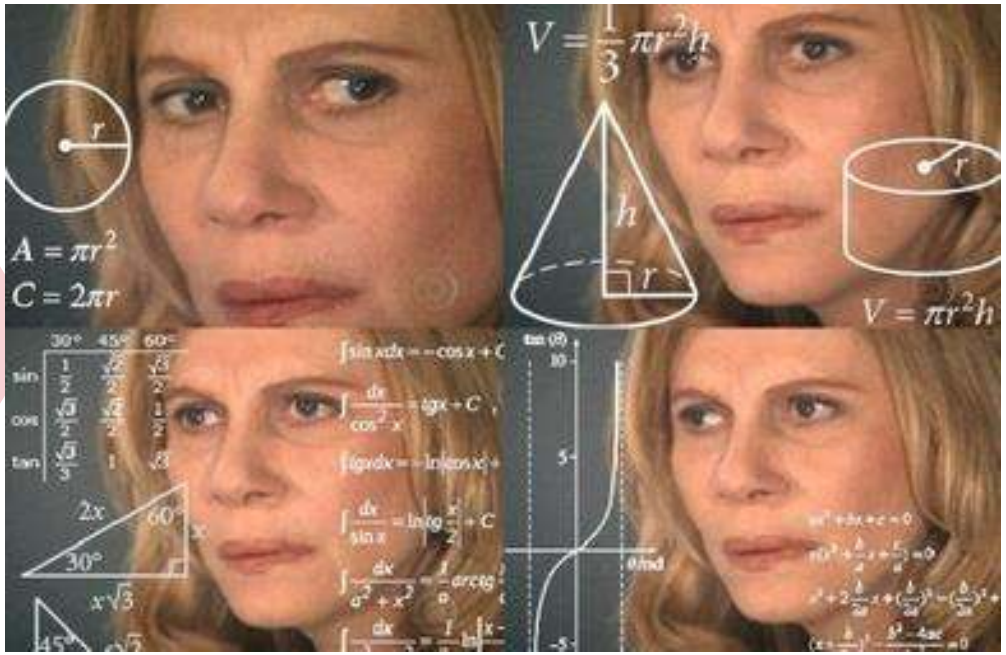


Admins must prepare a VM, think about managing PD and VM installations.

Windows Apps Provisioning

Manual process/Past

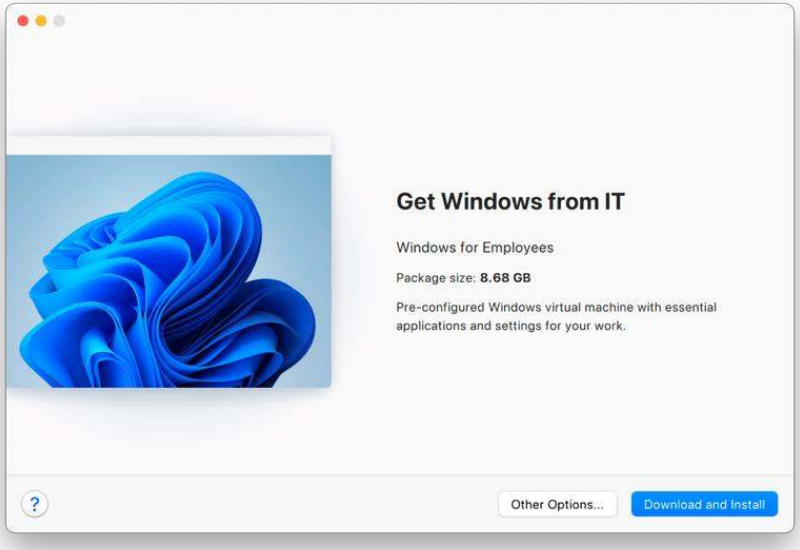


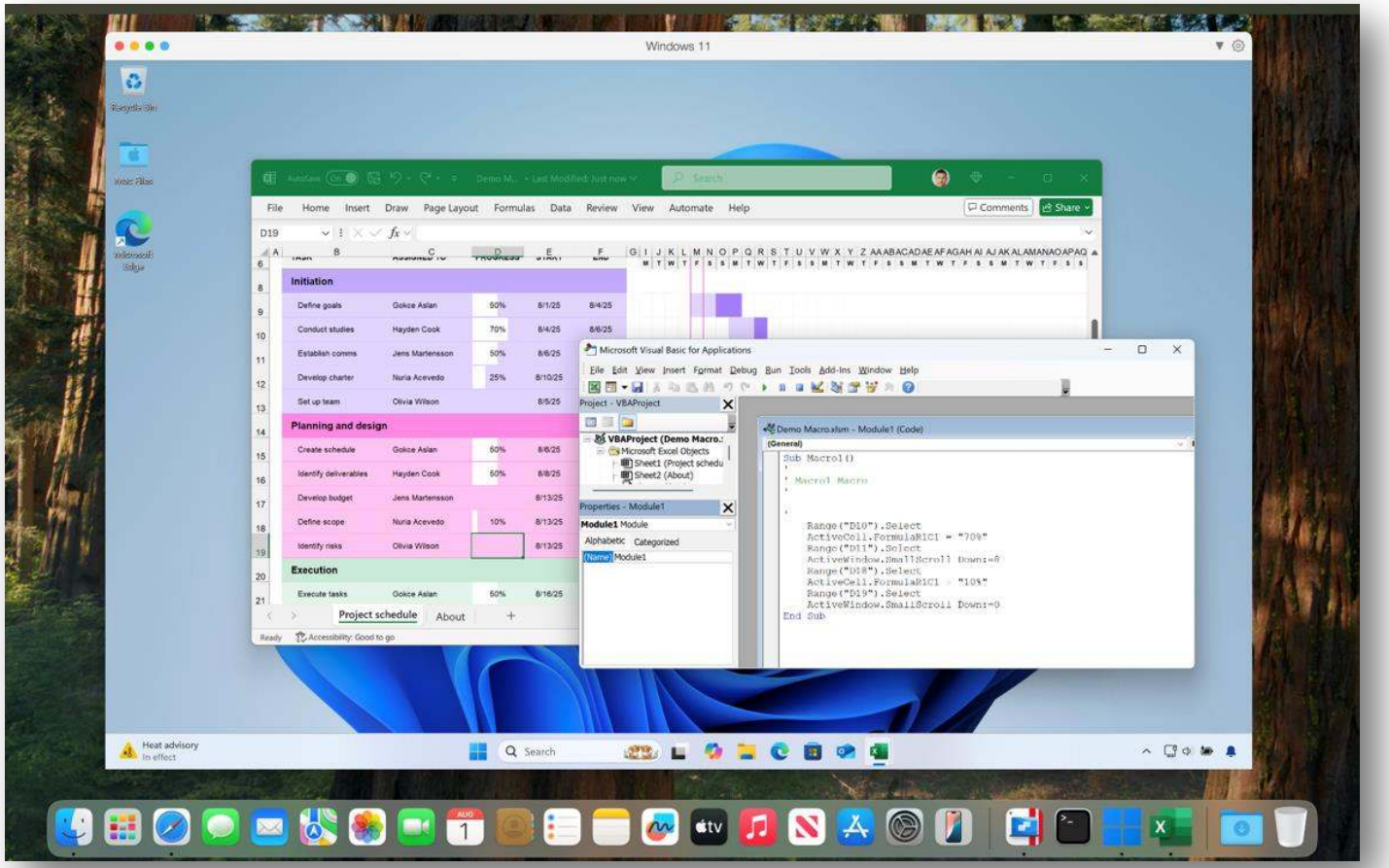


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VM Delivery: VM + OS + App

CURRENT · VM-FOCUSED

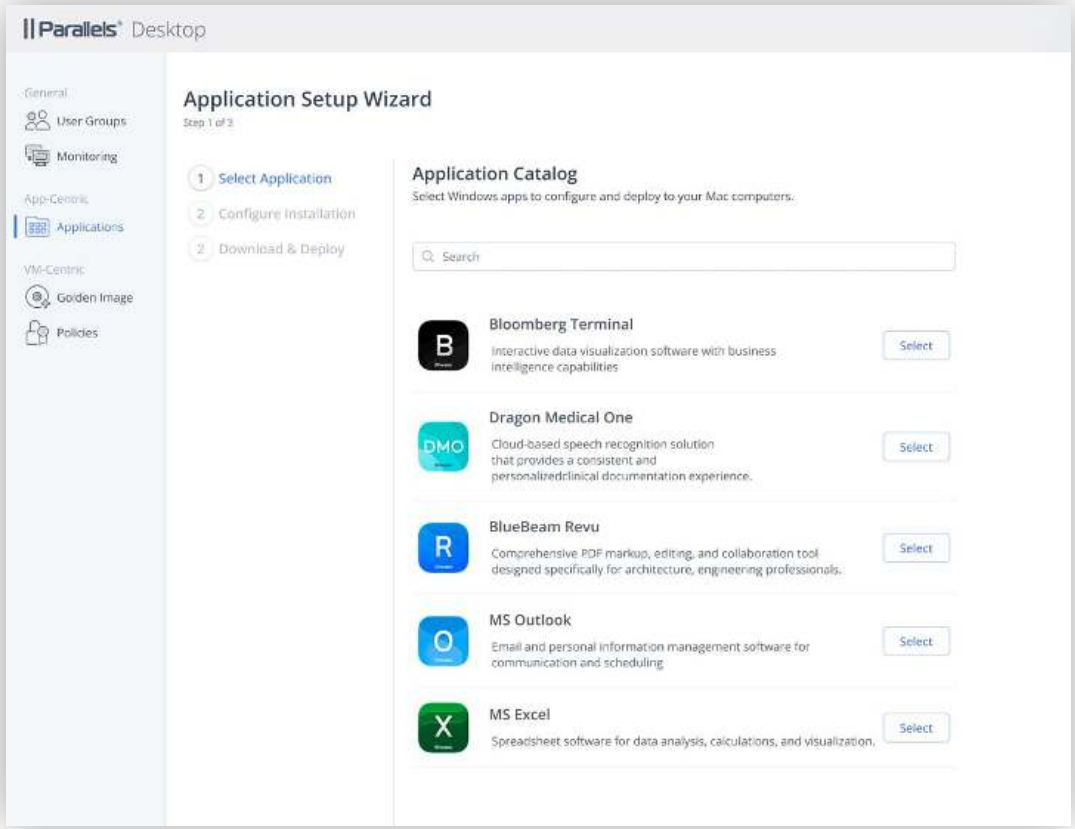


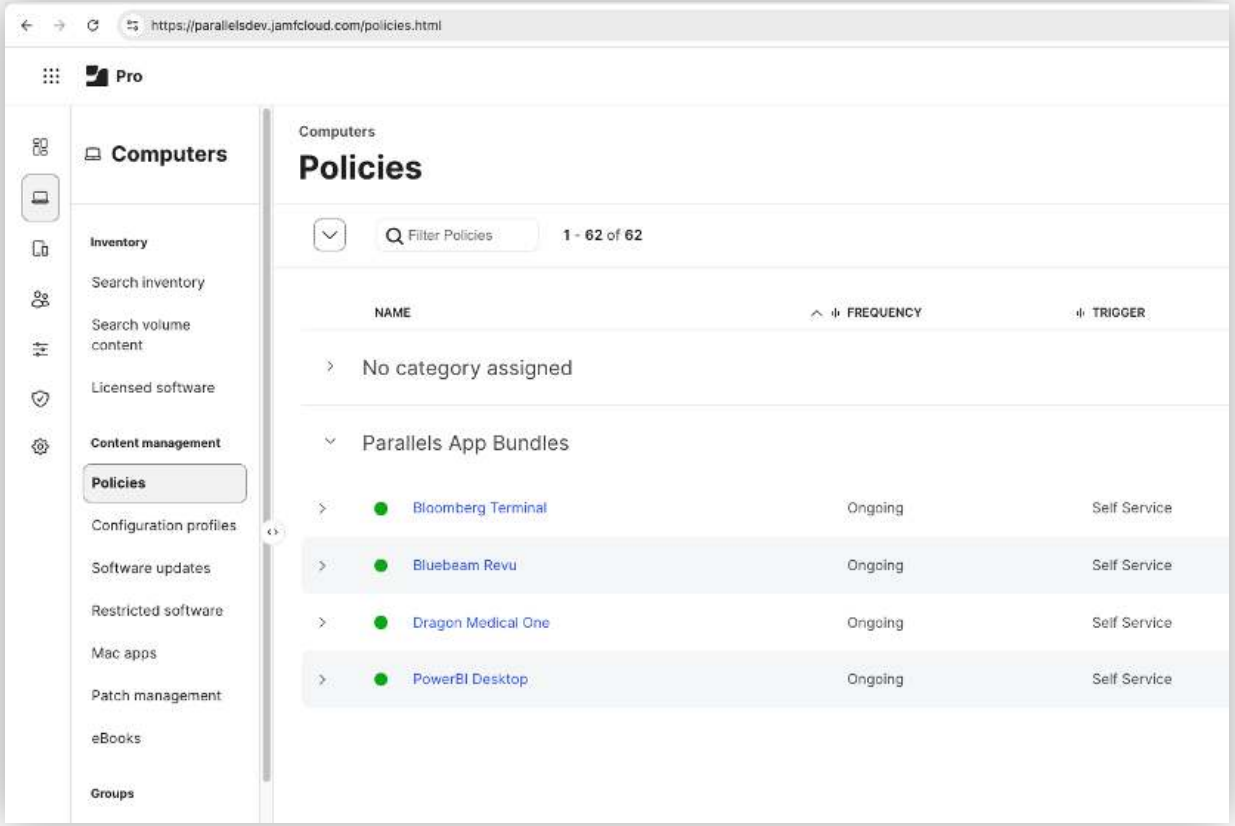


Users are often exposed to a whole Windows desktop — taskbar, Start menu, every app.

App Delivery: Admin experience

FUTURE · APP-FOCUSED





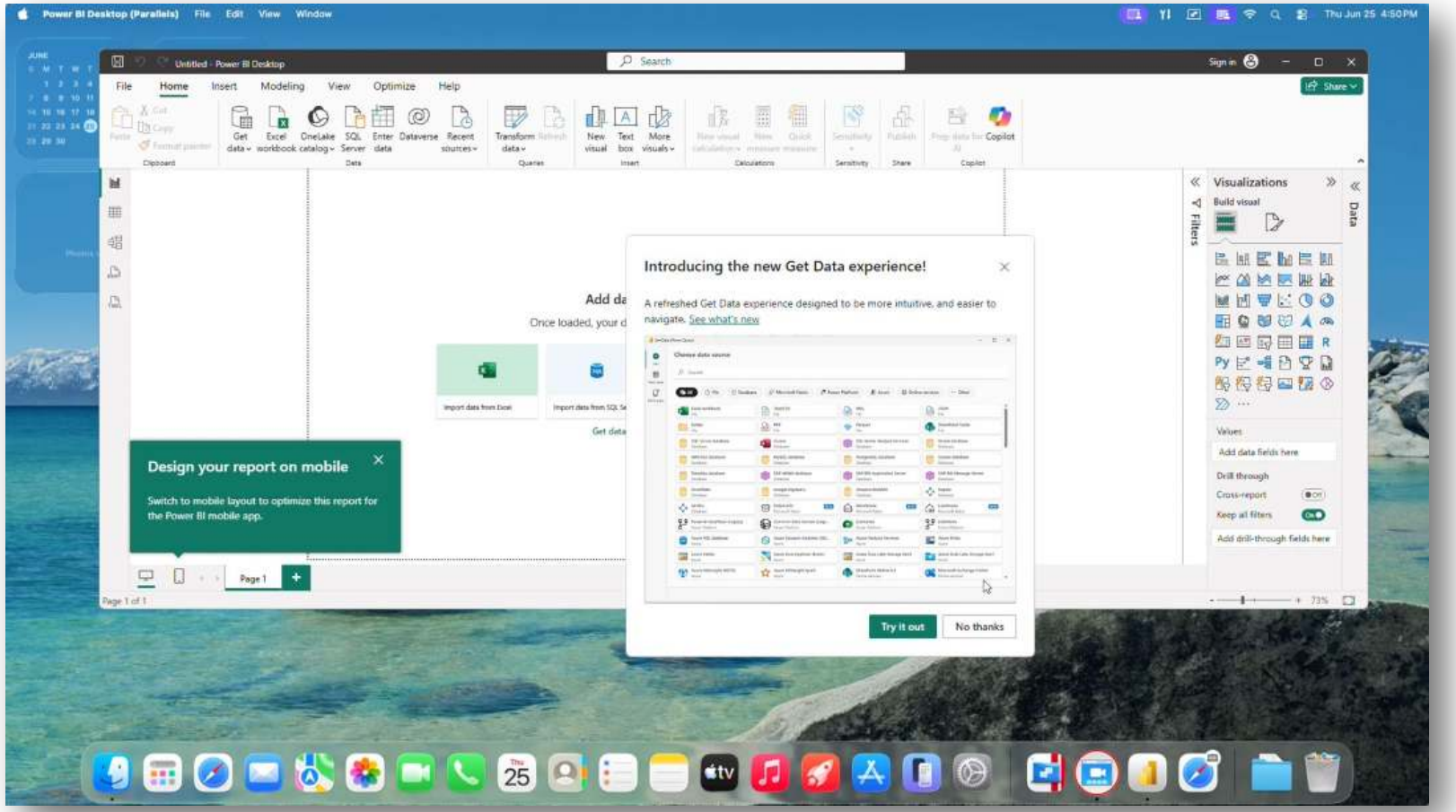
Deliver a Windows app package through Mac MDM like any macOS app.

The package will take care of setting up the environment and the app for users.

New!

App Delivery: End-user experience

FUTURE · APP-FOCUSED

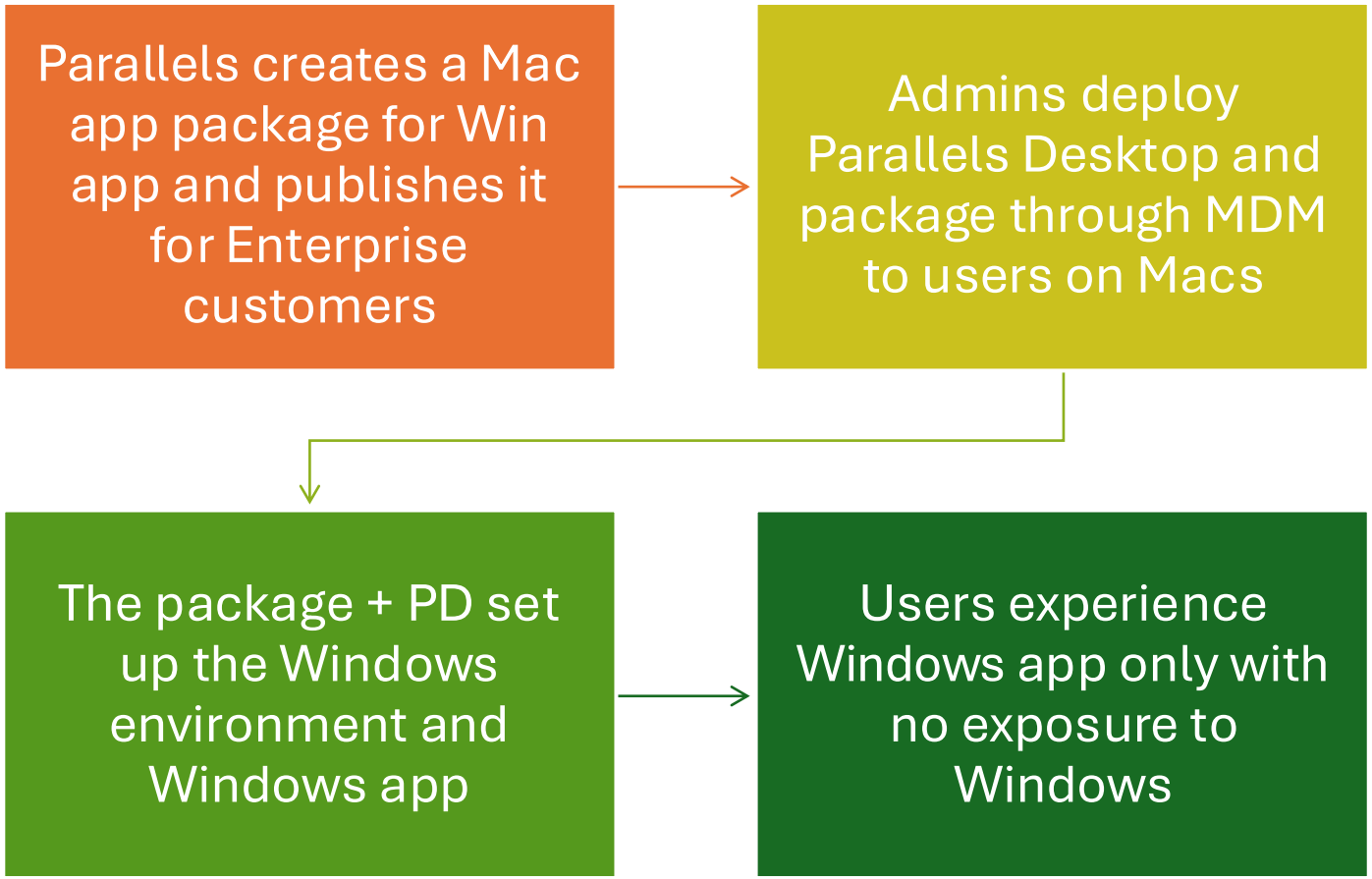


Just launch the Windows application like a native macOS App.

No Windows desktop — the VM runs hidden underneath.

New!

Parallels Desktop App Delivery



Windows Application Delivery Lifecycle

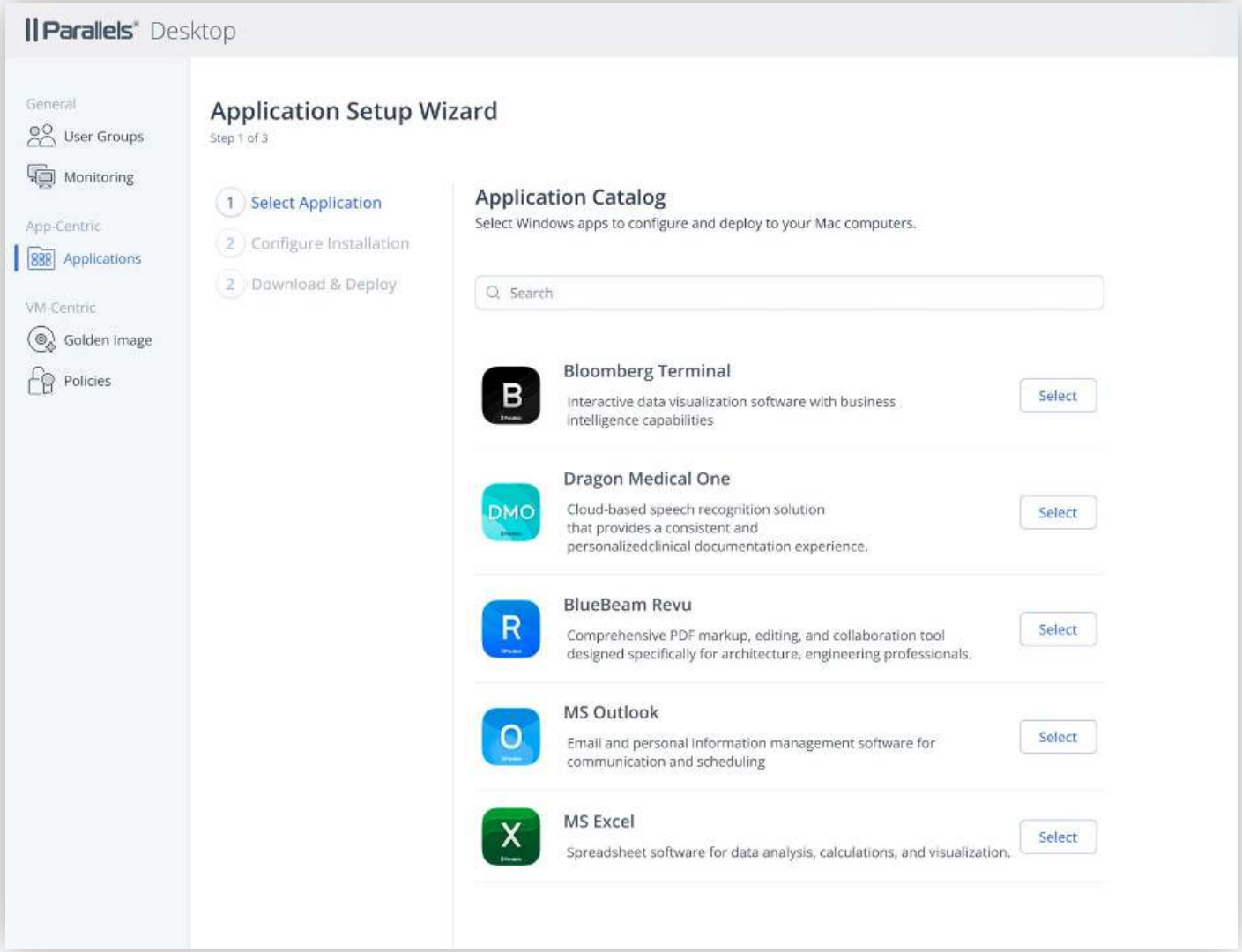
New!

Admin Experience

Parallels Desktop for Enterprise

Windows Apps Collection by Parallels

Collection of pre-built Windows app Mac packages

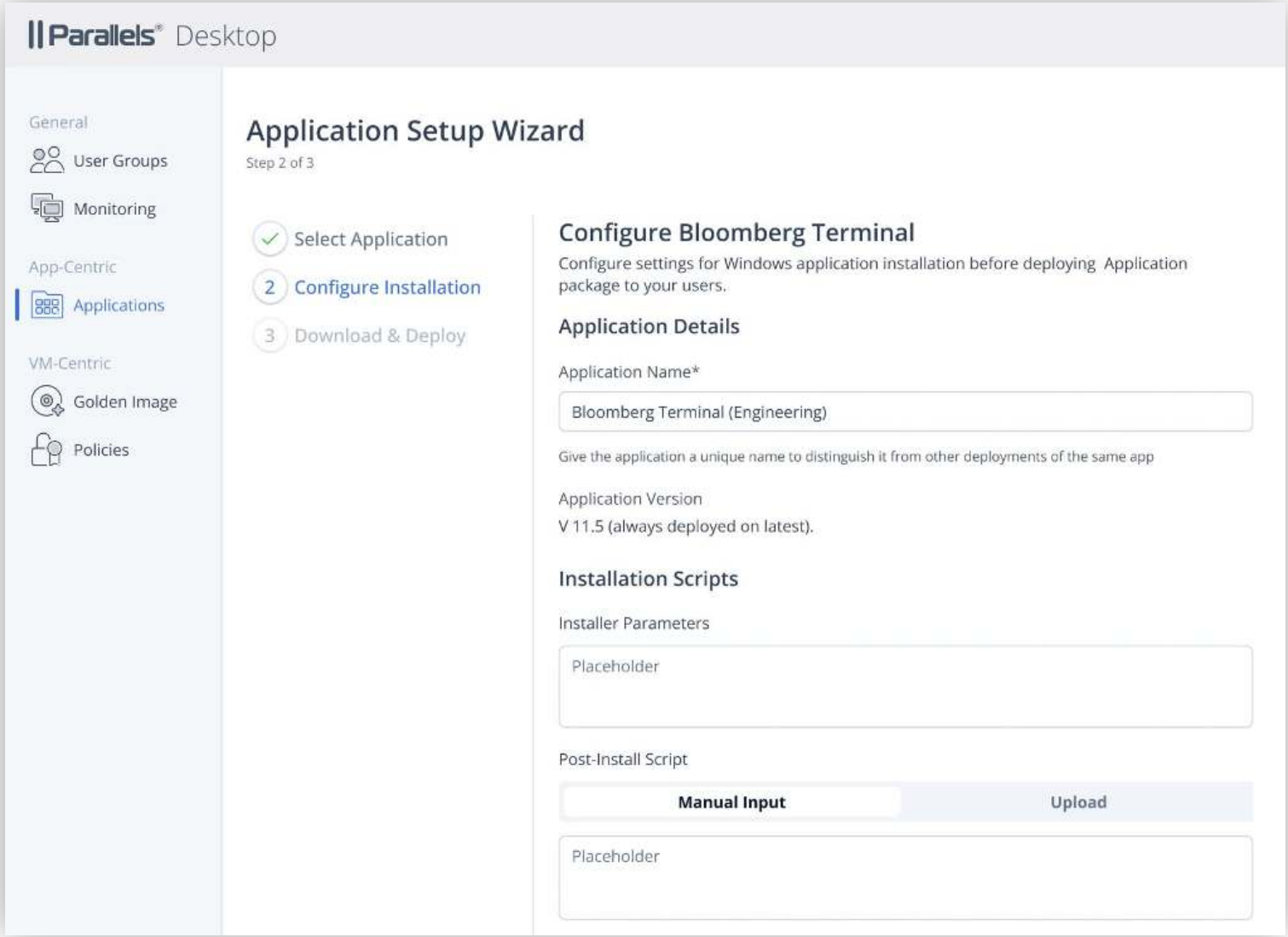


Parallels creates a Mac package for Win app

The package published on PDE MP

Windows App installation configuration

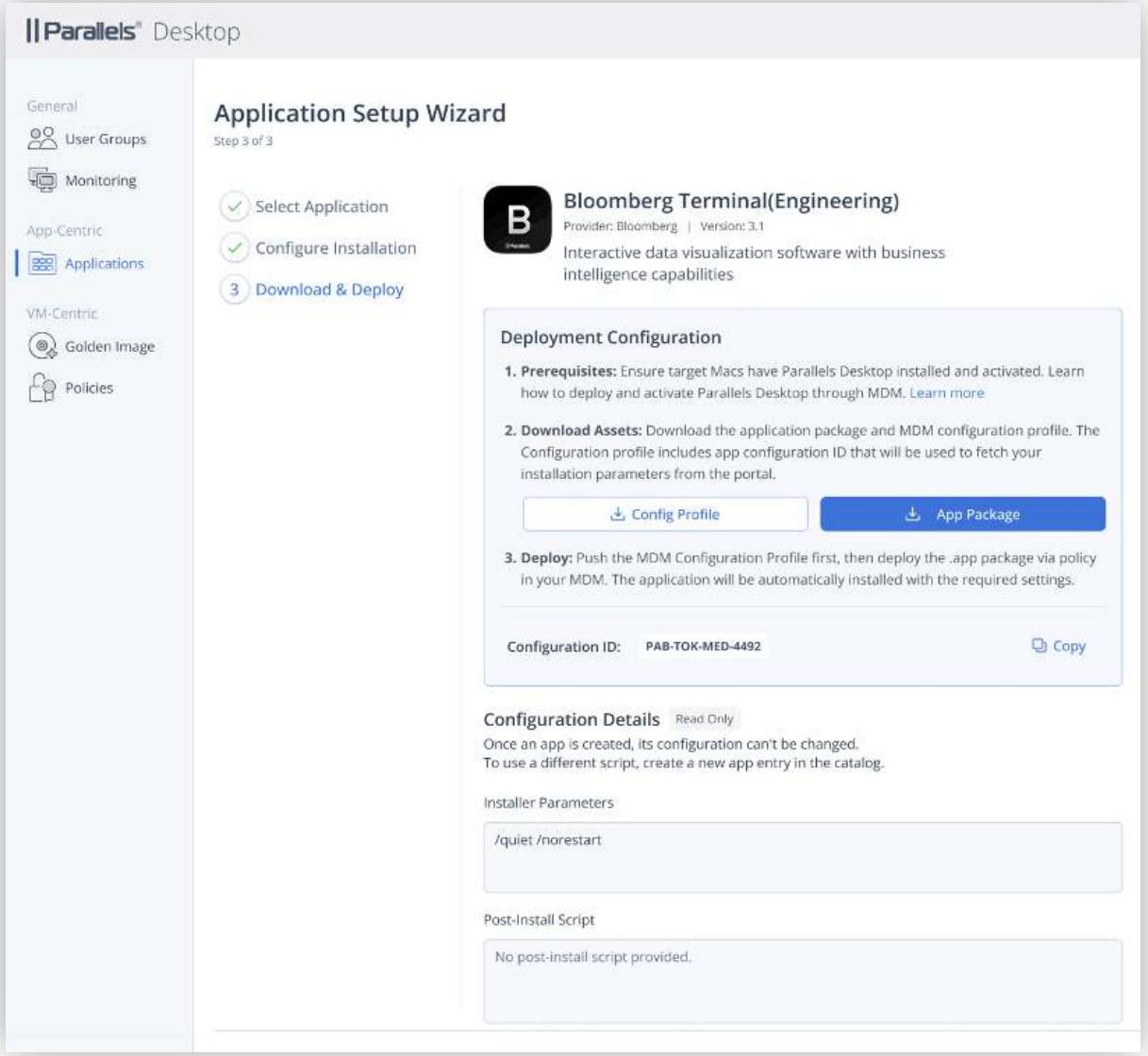
App package configuration for installation (scripts, configuration files, etc)



Admin sets up package settings and downloads PKG

Windows App Assets

Deployment content: Mac app package + configuration information via profile

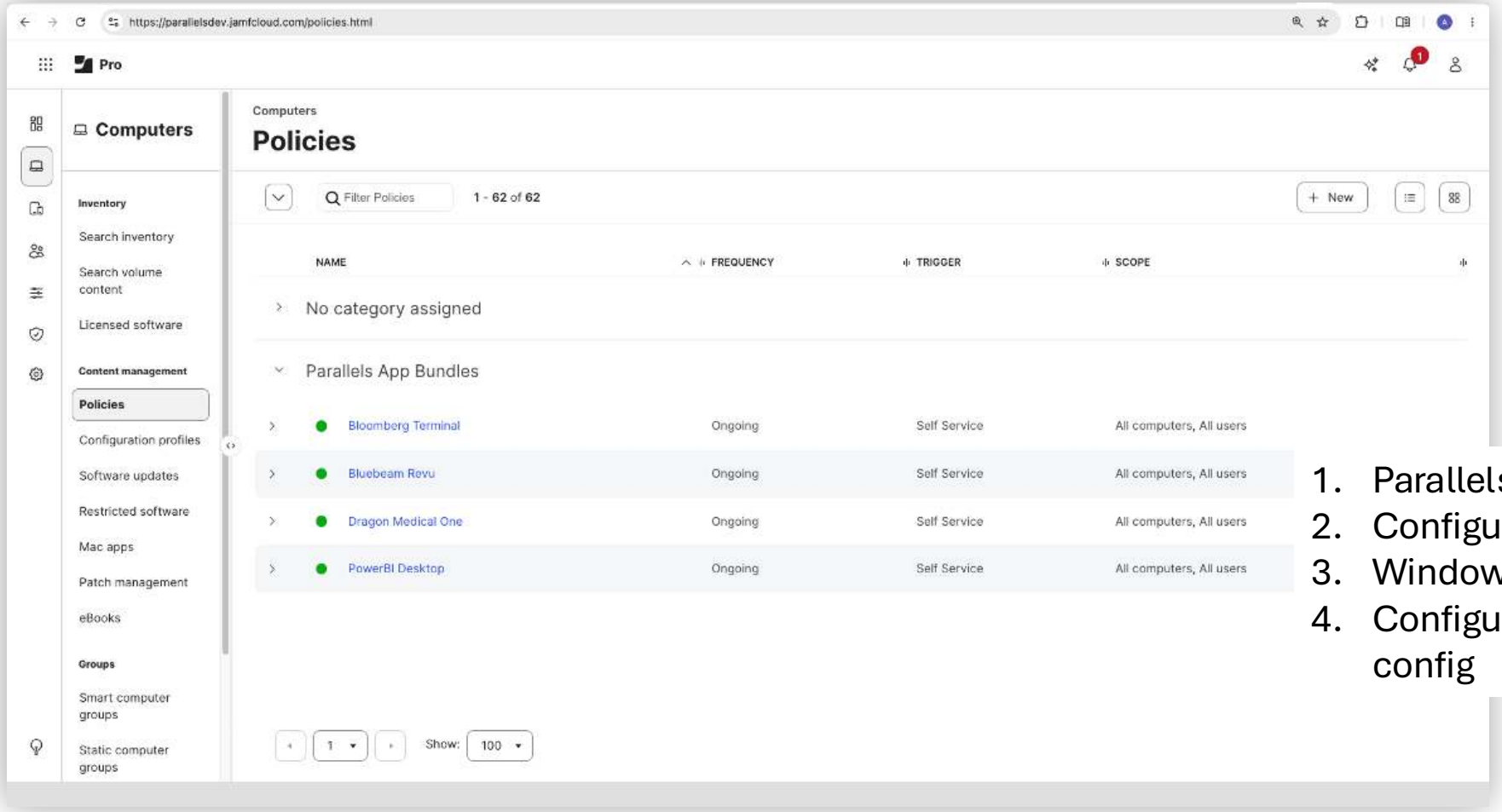


Admin sets up app package settings and downloads PKG



Windows App deployment via MDM

Deploy Parallels Desktop + Mac app package + configuration profile to your users



Admin adds PKG to their MDM and deploys to users (+ Parallels Desktop)

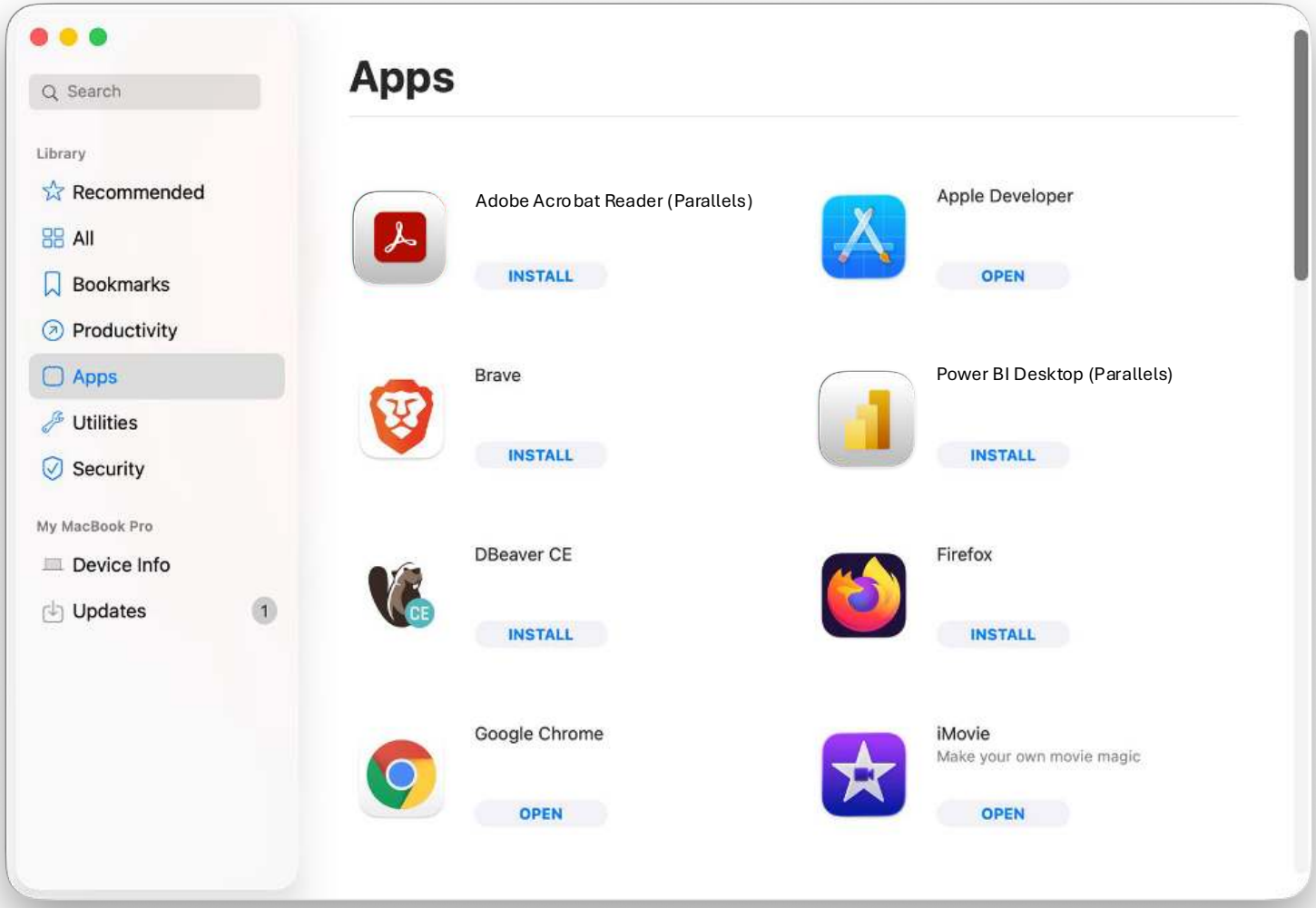
1. Parallels Desktop via app catalog
2. Configuration profile for activation
3. Windows App package via policy
4. Configuration profile for Windows app config

End-user experience

Native experience, invisible Windows

App package endpoint delivery

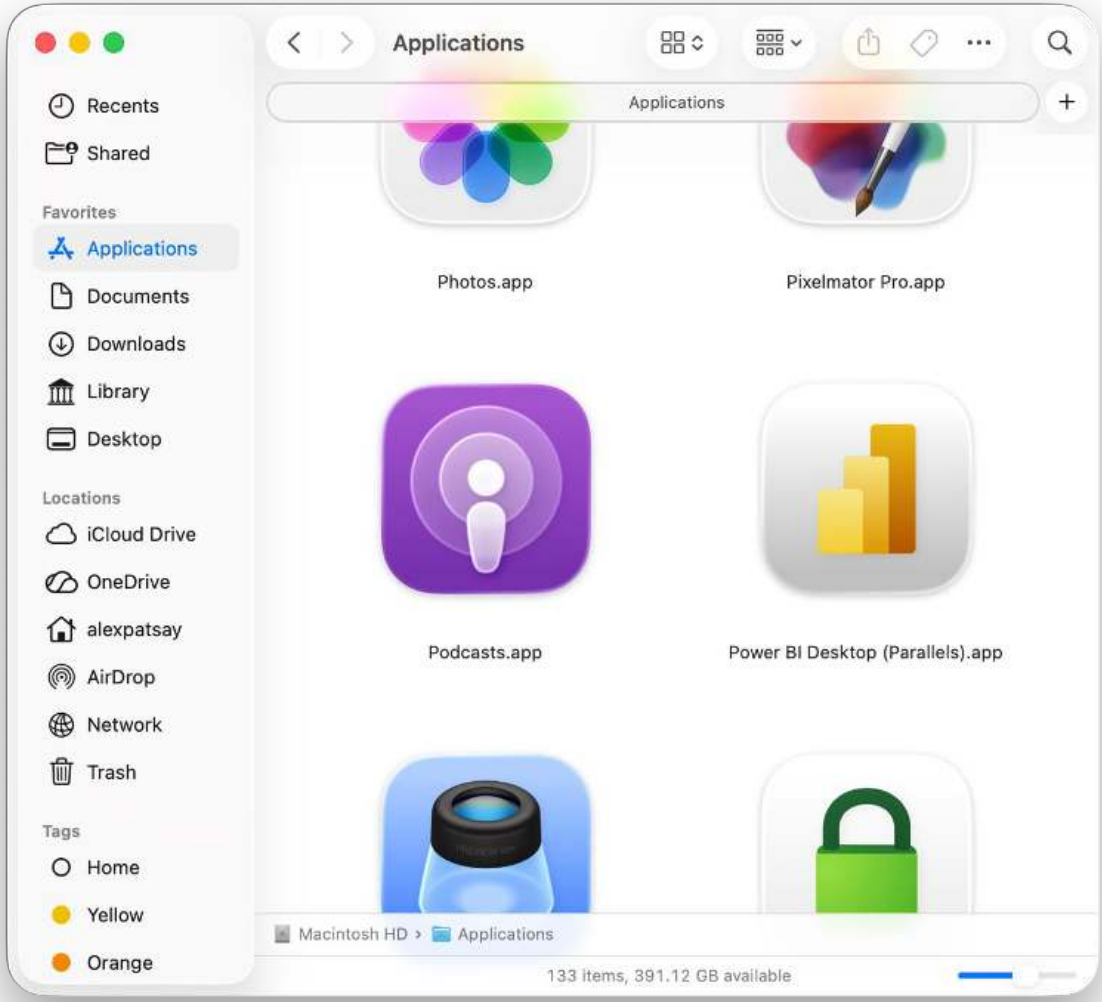
Deliver as package+policy or deploy (install) the package (or let users self-install)



Packaged Mac app is installed on a Mac

macOS application installed as a result

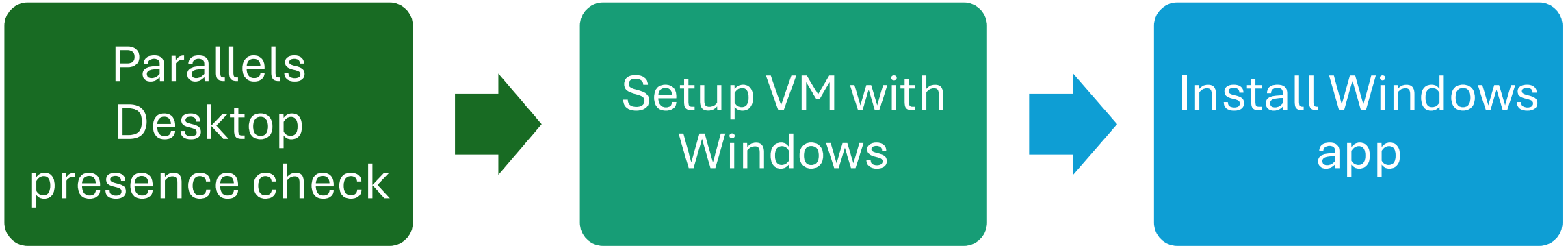
Parallels App Package installed in /Applications w/icon in Dock and ready to be launched



Packaged Mac app is installed on a Mac

App Delivery environment setup

Things required to run a Windows app



App Delivery: first launch + setup

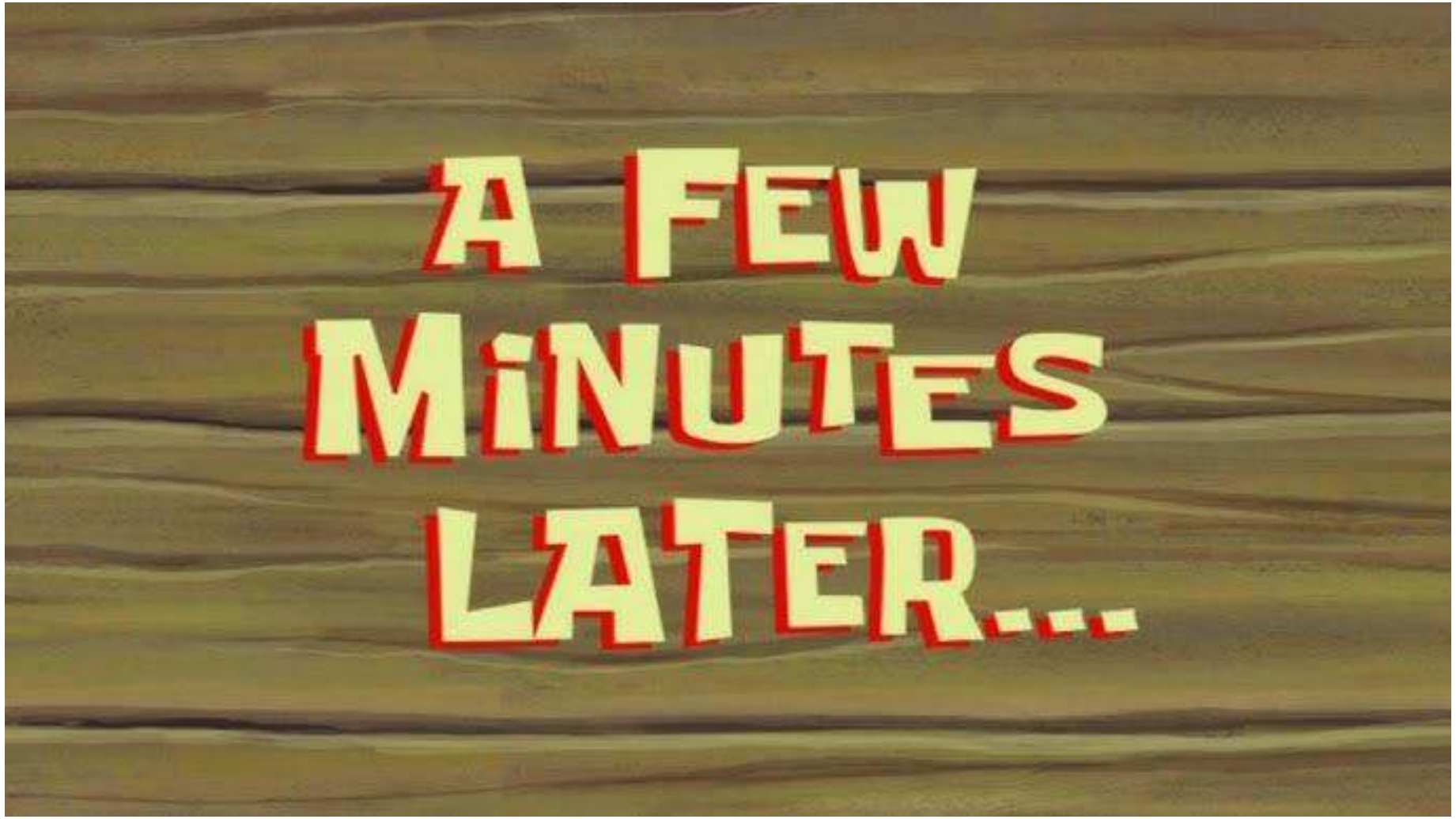
Installation and configuration information obtained from Parallels backend



Parallels Desktop creates a VM and installs Windows app

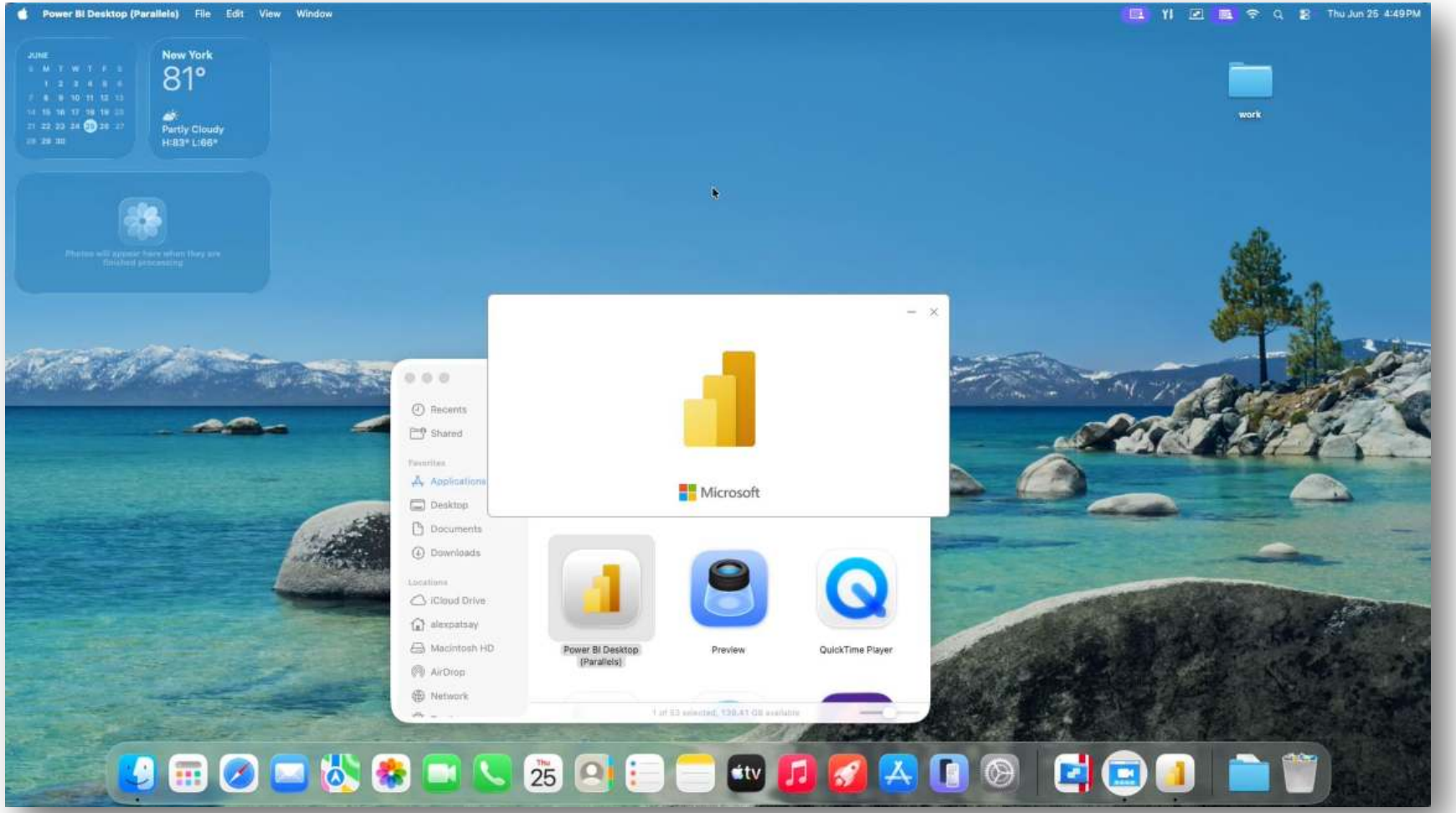
App Delivery: first launch + setup

Windows installed and set up, app installer downloaded



App Delivery: first launch + setup

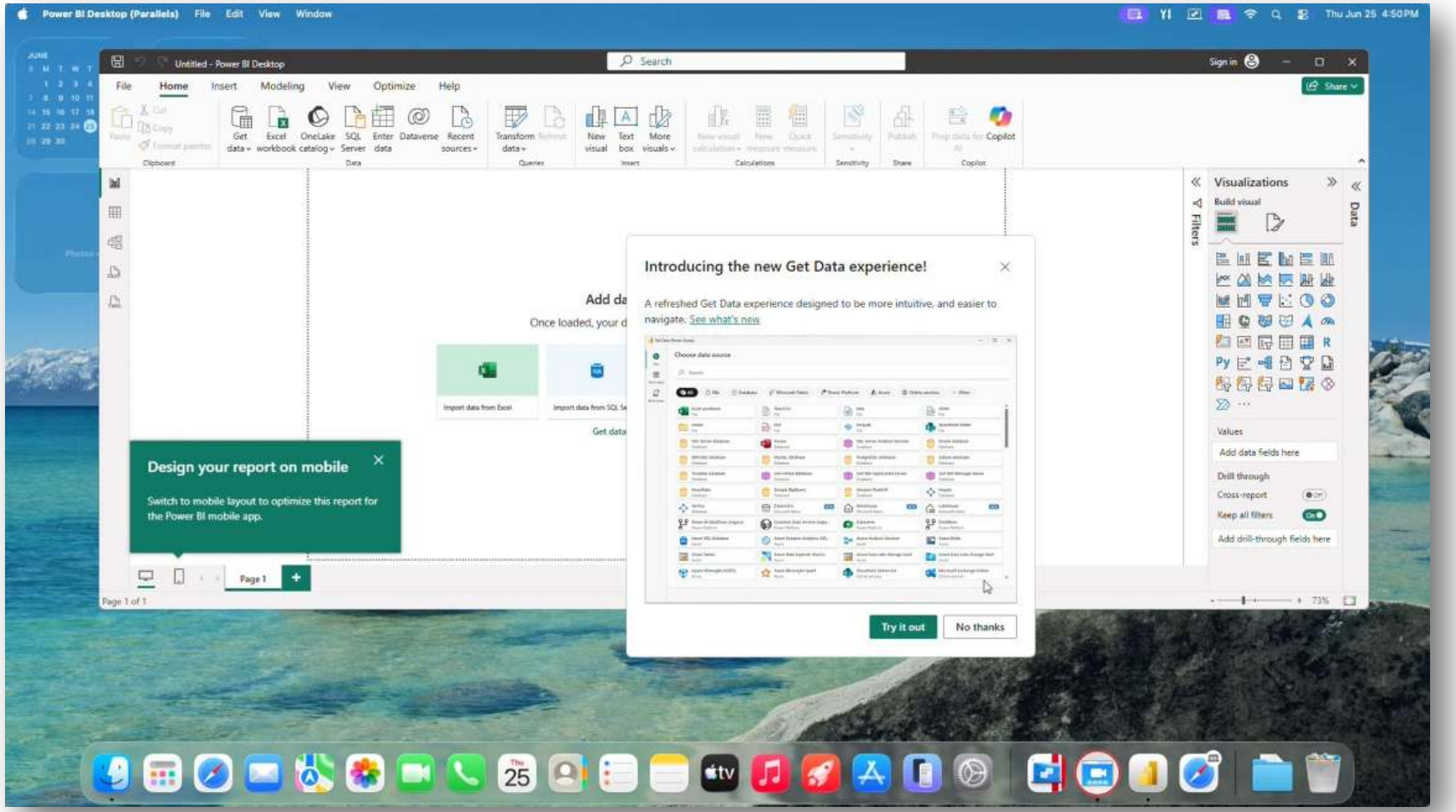
The end result of the initial setup — installed guest app in Coherence mode



Windows app launches in Coherence mode

App delivery: first launch + setup

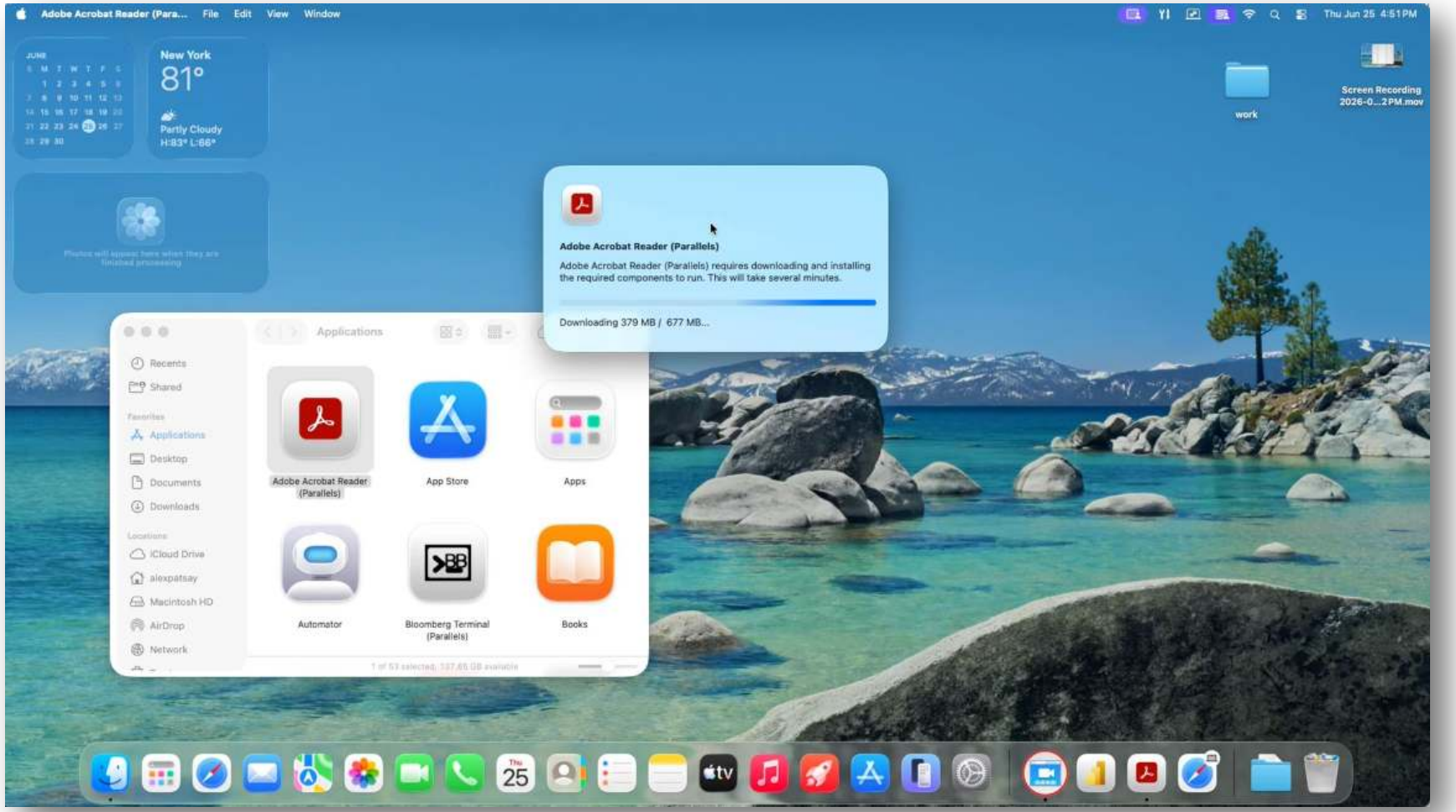
The end result of the initial setup — installed guest app in SAM/Coherence mode



Windows app launches in Coherence mode

App delivery: installing a second app

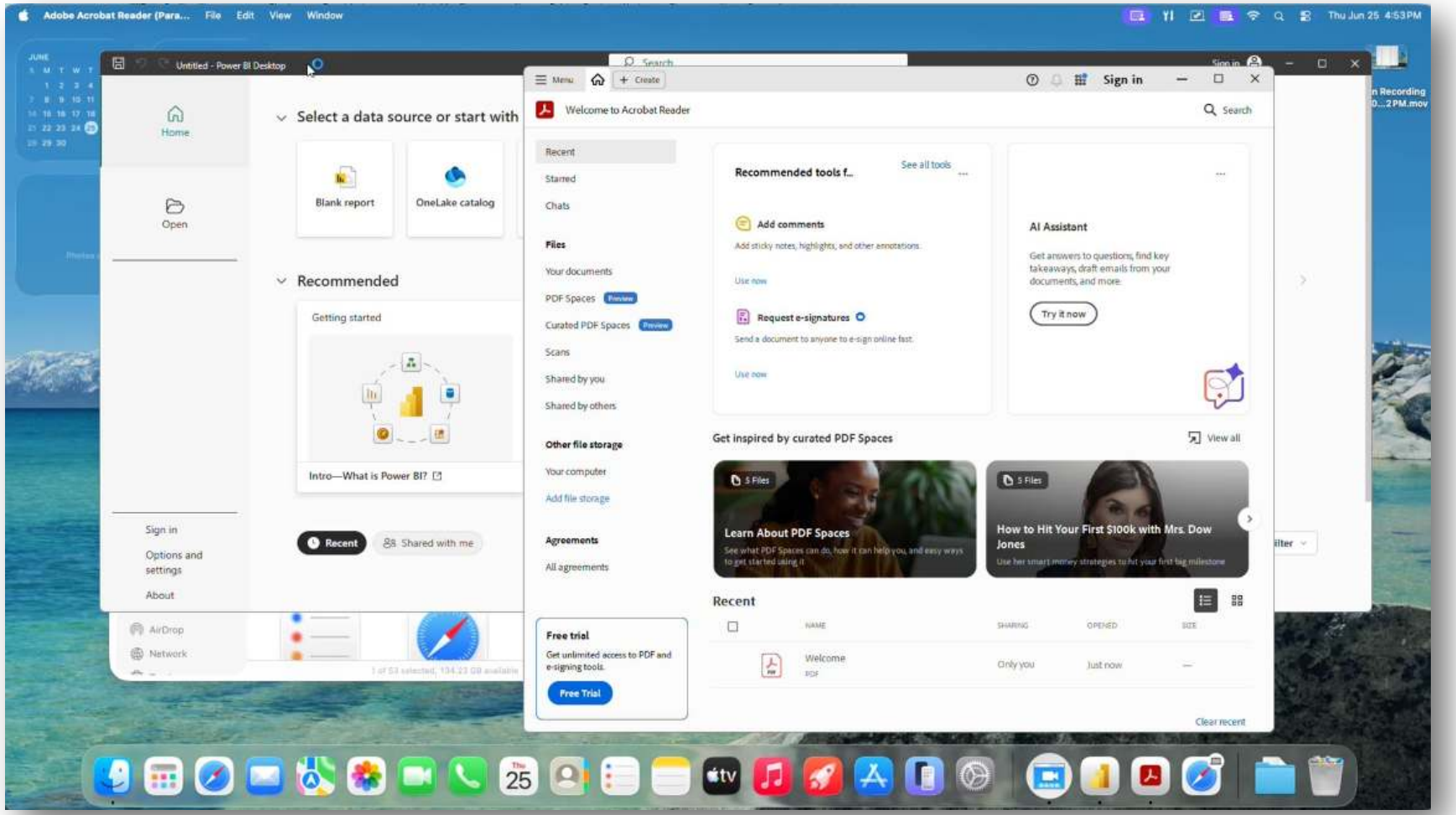
No need to set up another VM, only the app gets downloaded and installed



Second Windows app is installed in the same VM

Post-install Windows app launch

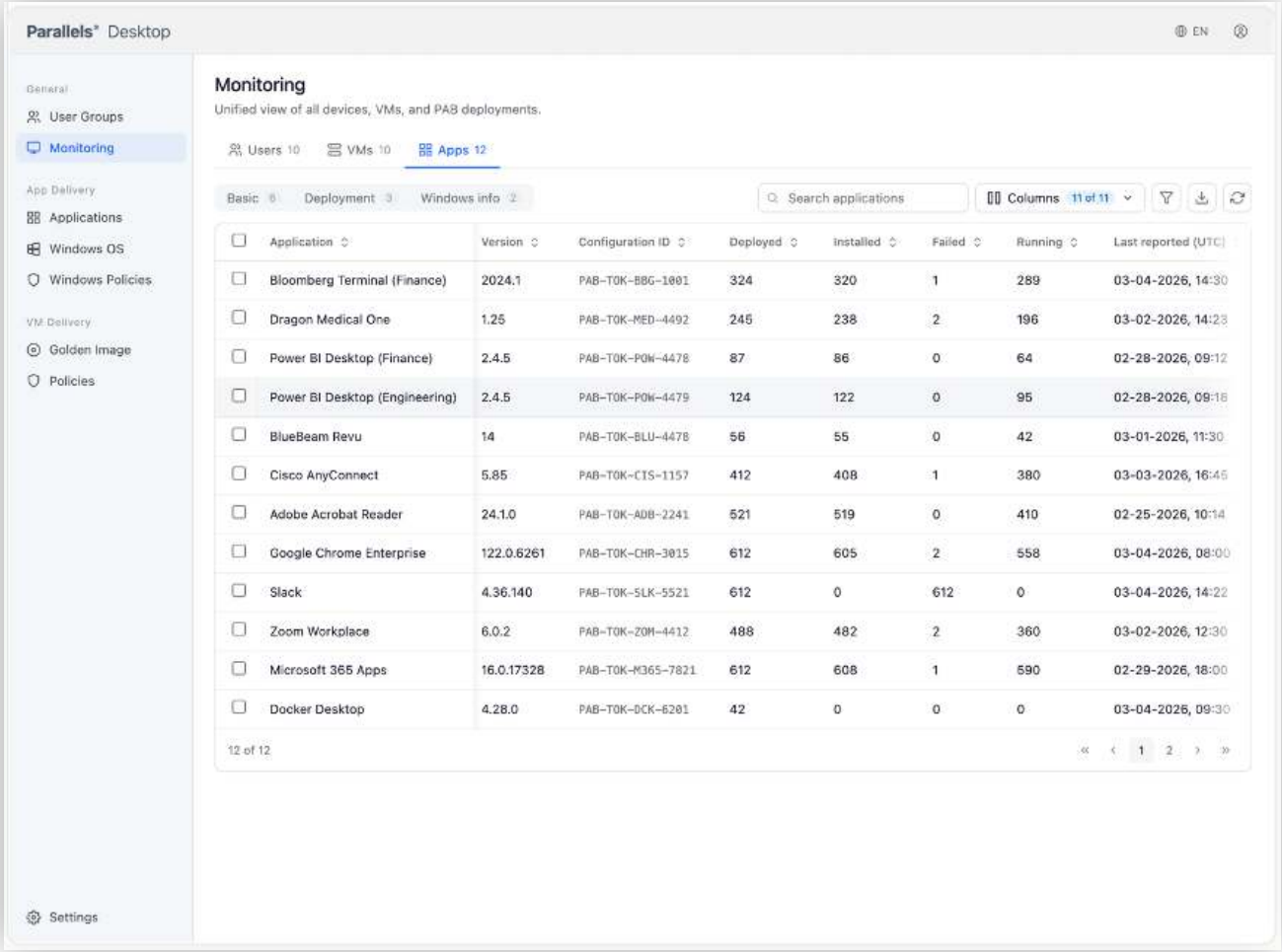
Users can use icon in the Applications folder/the Dock to launch app as any other native app



Both Windows apps working in Coherence mode side by side

Monitoring for deployed App packages

Separate reporting for the deployed app packages



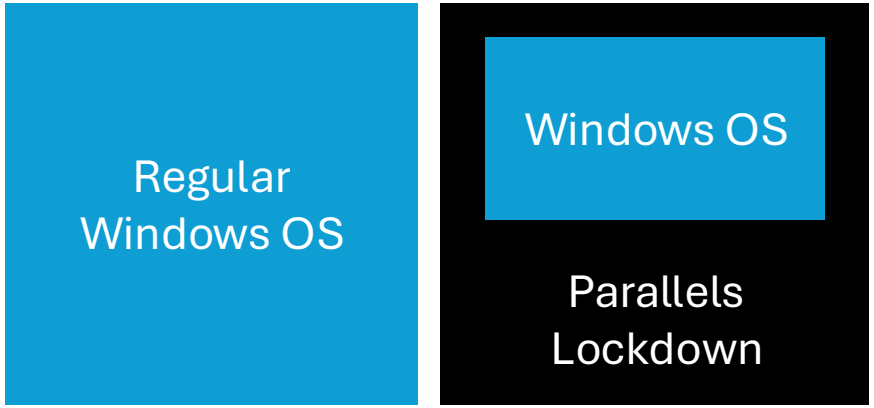
Managing the Windows Layer

Lockdown, activation, updates, and monitoring

Windows as a runtime, not an endpoint.

Parallels Apps Delivery technology executes Windows apps on Mac **without exposing Windows as a general-purpose OS.**

The next slides outline the architecture, configuration baseline, and security ownership model, so you can assess whether this constitutes a new endpoint that requires an independent management scope.



Core idea:
Given the isolation and lockdown described on the next slides, we believe the Windows layer may require MINIMUM independent EDR, patch management, and audit coverage, and the existing macOS security posture will cover it.

Windows lockdown

Minimize, secure, and hide the managed Windows installation

THE FOUR LEVERS

Performance

Stop indexing, Superfetch, P2P updates & telemetry timers

WSearch / SysMain → Manual stop background indexing and Superfetch pre-allocation.

DODownloadMode = 99 disable peer-to-peer Delivery Optimization bandwidth sharing.

CDPSvc / CDPUserSvc → Disabled kill Connected Devices Platform background activity.

NoDesktop · blank wallpaper · DisableSearch clean, distraction-free surface.

Suppress update & crash dialogs no user-facing interruptions during sessions.

Lockdown

Block shortcuts, Task Mgr, Control Panel; hide C:, bypass WinRE

NoWinKeys = 0xffffffff disable all Windows-key shortcuts (Win+R, Win+X, Win+D…).

DisableTaskMgr · NoControlPanel block Task Manager and Control Panel / Settings.

NoDrives = 4 hide the C: drive from Explorer and file dialogs.

Disable HKCU/HKLM Run · AutoRun off no unsupervised auto-start or autorun.inf vectors.

NoConnectedUser · IgnoreAllFailures local-account only; bypass recovery environment.

Bloat removal

Strip 32 apps, 12 capabilities, Edge & OOBE reinstalls

32 AppX packages deprovisioned Xbox stack, Bing apps, Store, Teams (consumer), Copilot…

12 optional capabilities via DISM WebView2, IE shim, WMP, PowerShell ISE, OneSync…

Edge actively removed scheduler, registry DACL, RunOnce uninstall command.

UScheduler OOBE queue cleared prevents reinstallation after imaging.

DisableWindowsConsumerFeatures = 1 no silently-installed promoted apps.

Privacy / Telemetry

Disable DiagTrack, appraisal, usage insights, health svc

DiagTrack → Manual disable the main Microsoft telemetry pipeline.

wuqisvc → Disabled stop Usage & Quality Insights data collection.

InventorySvc / whesvc → Manual halt inventory/compatibility appraisal & Windows Health.

PcaSvc / DPS → Disabled remove Program Compatibility & Diagnostic Policy pipelines.

Feedback Hub removed no diagnostic data or feedback sent externally.

Detection and control already operate on the Mac host, not inside Windows.

LAYER 1 · macOS HOST — the managed endpoint

EDR file scanning, macOS TCC privacy enforcement, and MDM policy run here

Files live on macOS (not inside Windows) via Shared Folders. EDR scans file content at rest. Note: process attribution is limited — file I/O from Windows apps surfaces as a Parallels process on macOS. TCC governs camera, mic, and peripherals independently of Windows.

EDR · file-at-rest scan | **macOS TCC · privacy** | **MDM / Jamf / Intune** | **Network firewall · NAT**

LAYER 2 · PARALLELS CONTROL PLANE — delivery and mediation gate

Controls which macOS folders Windows apps can access; gates all app delivery

Shared Folder scope is policy-configurable per ”App” — a defined working set, not the full Mac filesystem. Other macOS app sandboxes are not visible to Windows. Apps reach Windows only as signed "Apps” via the Orchestrator.

App Orchestrator · PAD-only | **Protection Controller · folder scope** | **Runtime maintenance · Parallels-owned**

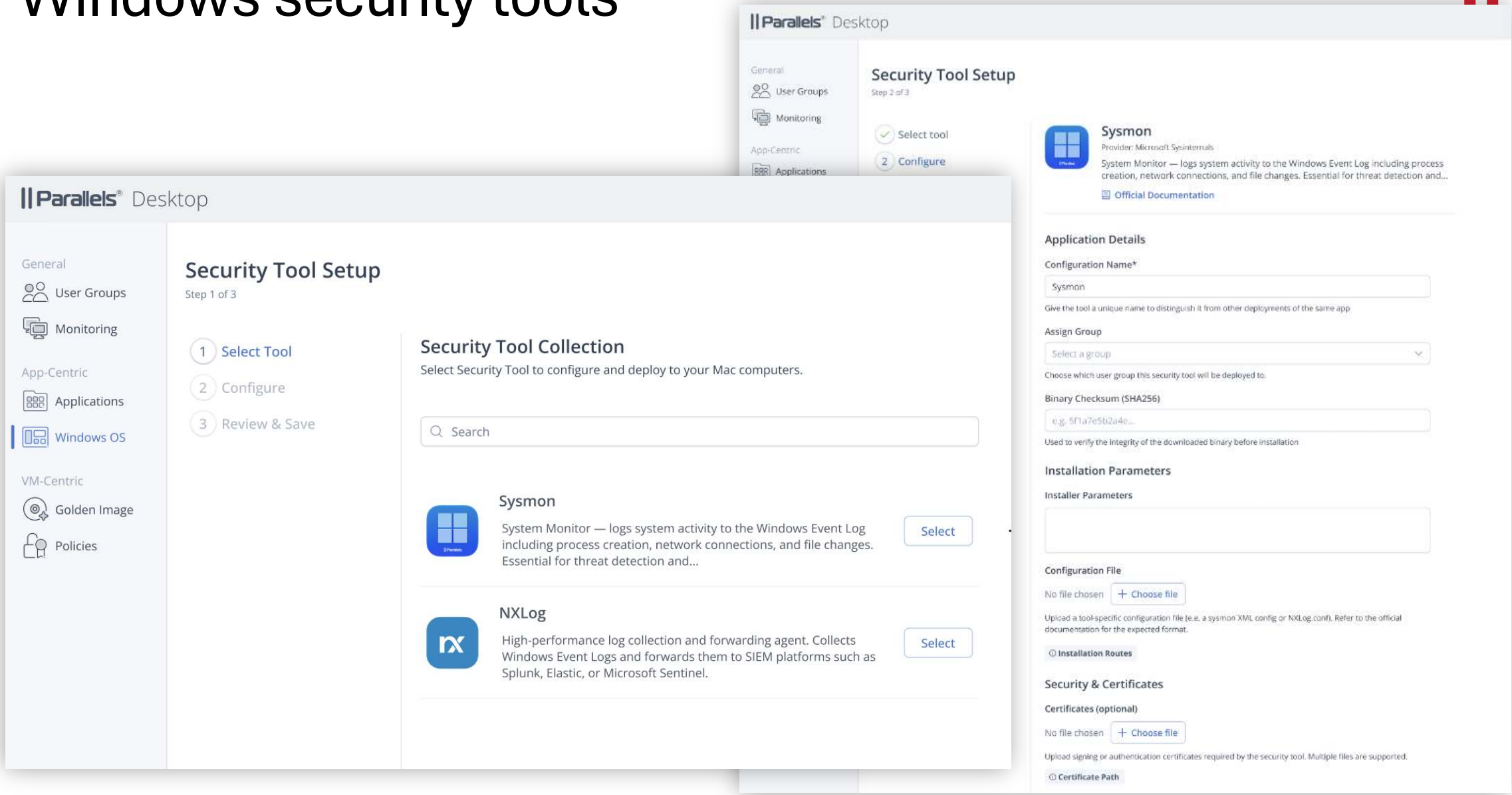
LAYER 3 · WINDOWS RUNTIME — sealed execution environment

Executes approved app binaries. NAT network. No desktop, no shell, no user access to OS.

No browser · no email · no cloud sync · no scripting · no app store · NAT-only outbound · no inbound network exposure → exfiltration surface inside Windows is structurally narrow.

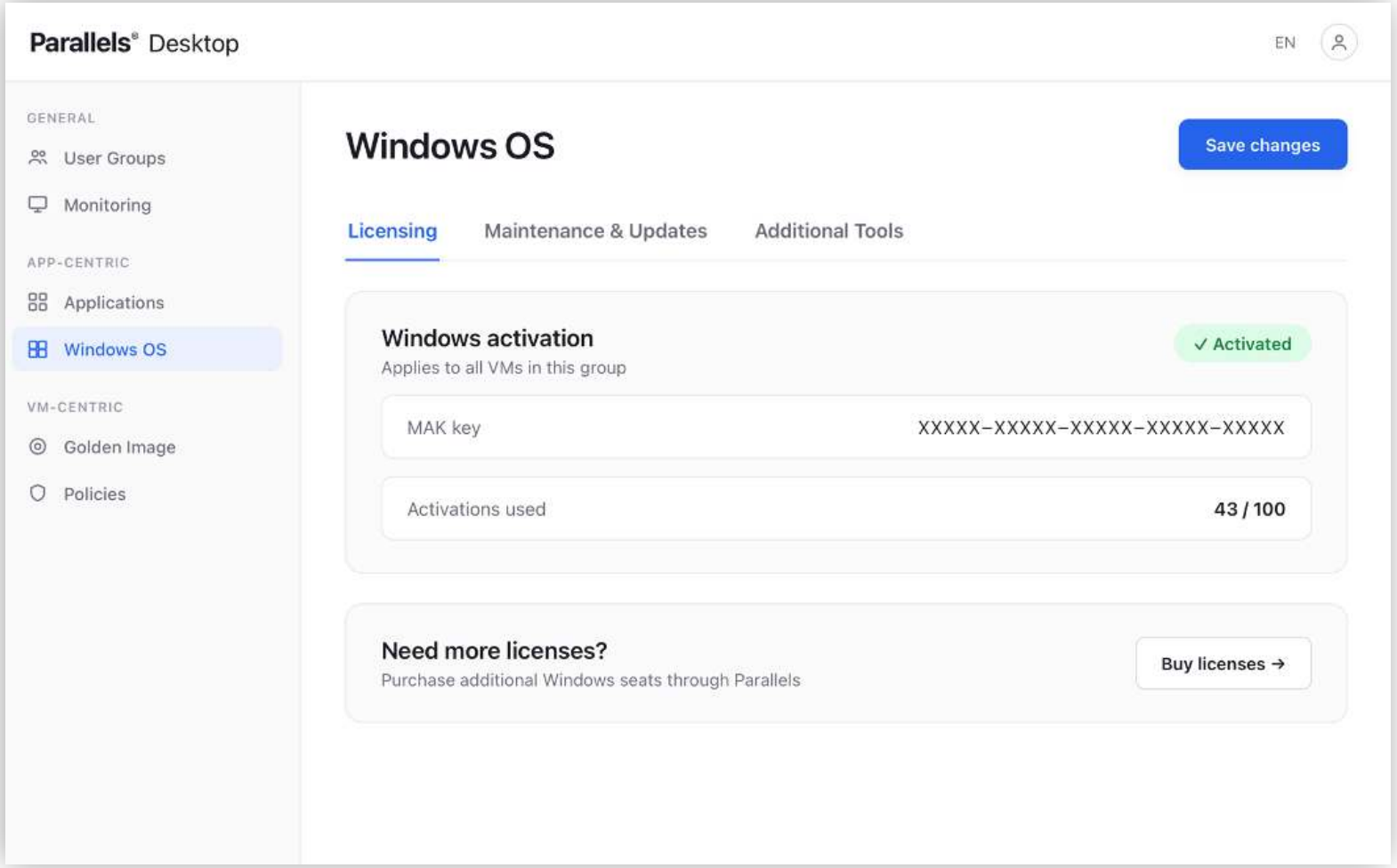
Windows sees only the files Parallels grants it. The Mac host remains the managed endpoint boundary.

Windows security tools



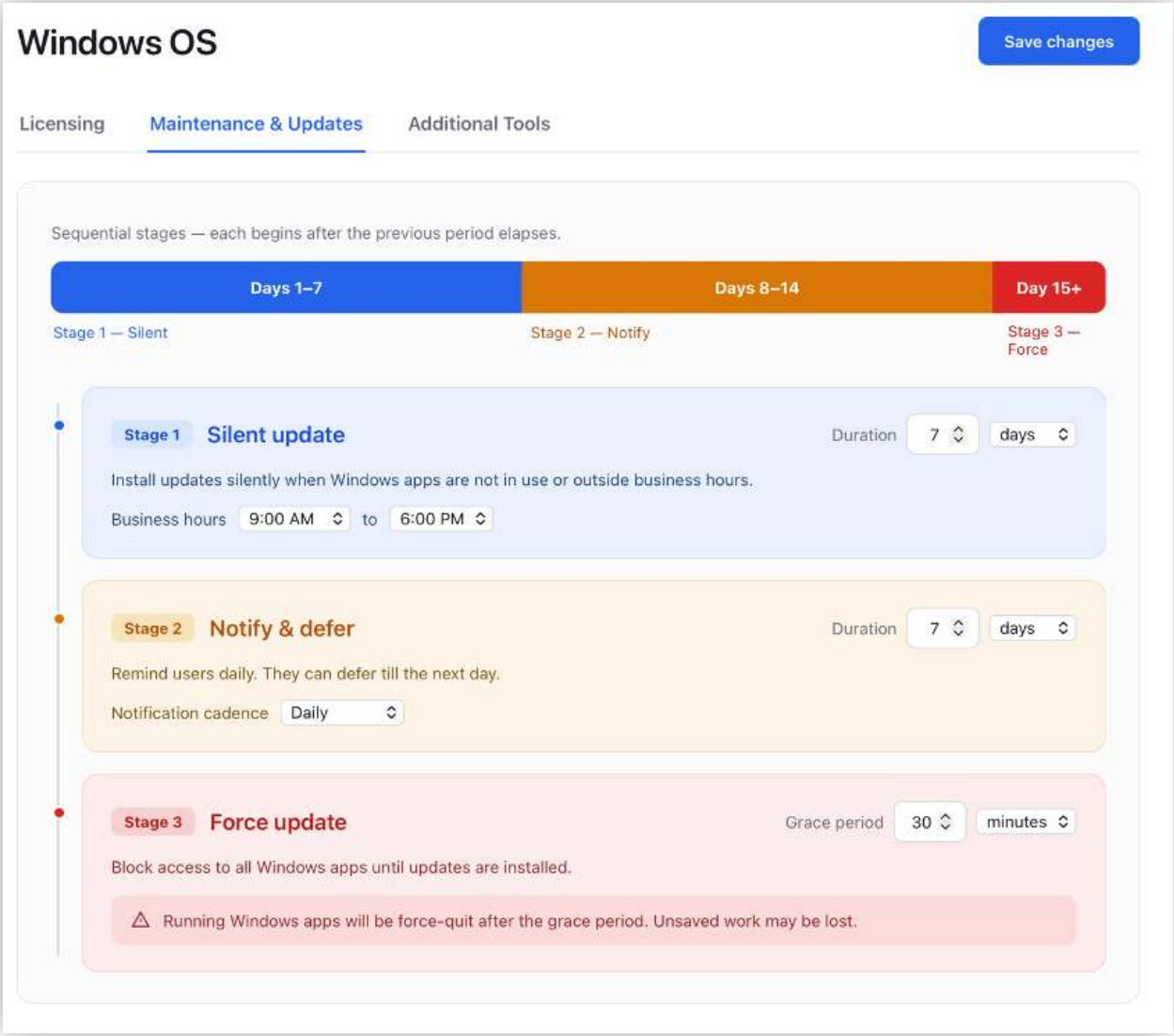
MAK-based Windows activation automation

Support for Windows activation (COMING LATER)



Windows updates management

Control updates applied to Windows (COMING LATER)



Summary



New delivery model

Windows apps reach Macs as single apps, not full VMs to hand off



A native experience

Users launch apps from the Dock; Windows runs hidden underneath



No new tooling

Package and deploy through your existing MDM, like any Mac app



macOS stays the managed endpoint

Windows is a sealed runtime, not a second OS to patch or audit

Windows as a runtime, not an endpoint.

Q&A

Mac Admins Slack: #parallels channel

@LubaKulakova and @Alex Patsay

Raffle

Session Feedback



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